

City of Cadillac**Utilities Department– Water Resources Division**

1121 Plett Road

Cadillac, MI 49601

September 4, 2025

Aaron Kline

Water Resources Division

Department of Environment, Great Lakes, and Energy (EGLE)

Cadillac District Office

P.O. Box 30458

Lansing, MI 48909-7958

RE: Corrective Action Plan in Response to NPDES CEI Evaluation – NPDES Permit No. MI0020257 Cadillac Wastewater Treatment Plant – June 10, 2025 Evaluation

Dear Mr. Kline,

Thank you for conducting the recent Compliance Evaluation Inspection (CEI) at the Cadillac Wastewater Treatment Plant (WWTP) on June 10, 2025. We appreciate the opportunity to review our operations with EGLE staff and acknowledge the findings and recommendations provided in your August 19, 2025 correspondence. This letter serves as our formal Corrective Action Plan (CAP) to address the identified issues and outline actions the City will take to ensure full compliance with our NPDES permit.

1. Improper Preservation of Ammonia Samples**Issue:**

As noted in your report, ammonia samples were not consistently preserved immediately with sulfuric acid, as required by 40 CFR Part 136, Table II.

Corrective Action:

- Effective immediately, all ammonia samples will be preserved with sulfuric acid at the time of collection, regardless of when analysis is to occur.
 - Laboratory staff have been retrained on the proper preservation requirements as of August 30, 2025, with documentation of training maintained on file.
 - A written SOP for sample preservation, aligned with 40 CFR Part 136, has been updated and reviewed with all staff involved in sampling and laboratory procedures.
-

2. Incomplete Submission – DMR-QA Study 44

Issue:

Although results from the DMR-QA 44 study were approvable, the submittal was incomplete and lacked the required data report form, laboratory list, and authorized signature.

Corrective Action:

- For future DMR-QA submissions, the City will ensure that the following are included:
 - Data Report Form (EPA Form 6400-01)
 - Complete list of laboratories used
 - Signature of the supervisor
 - Staff have been reoriented to the EPA and EGLE requirements for DMR-QA documentation. A checklist has been implemented to accompany all future submissions.
-

3. Effluent Violations (March 2023 – Present)

Issue:

Twelve (12) effluent violations were reported, including exceedances of daily and monthly limits for CBOD5, Ammonia Nitrogen, Total Copper, Total Phosphorus, and Dissolved Oxygen.

Corrective Action:

- Each effluent violation has been reviewed, and operational adjustments have been made to address loading, chemical dosing, and aeration efficiency.
 - Additional sampling and trending have been implemented to improve process control and identify causes of occasional parameter spikes.
 - As of August 2025, all parameters are within permit limits. Continued efforts will be made to maintain compliance, including ongoing staff training and improved process monitoring.
-

4. Schedule of Compliance Violations

Issue:

Eight (8) compliance schedule violations due to missed submittals in MiEnviro were identified dating back to March 6, 2023.

Corrective Action:

- A centralized compliance tracking calendar has been developed for permit deliverables, with multiple staff assigned to monitor due dates and upload documentation.
 - An internal review and checklist process has been established to ensure timely and accurate submittals moving forward.
-

5. Temporary Process Modification – Primary Clarifier Use**Acknowledgement and Intent:**

As discussed during the inspection, the facility has temporarily repurposed one of the three primary clarifiers as a gravity sludge thickening tank to improve solids handling efficiency.

- The City is currently evaluating process performance under this modification and expects to reach a decision regarding permanency soon.
 - If the modification proves beneficial and is to be made permanent, the City will:
 - Apply for a Part 41 construction permit.
 - Conduct a full evaluation of the facility's basis of design, confirming that the remaining two primary clarifiers meet all unit process capacity requirements.
 - Submit all engineering and design documentation to EGLE prior to initiating any permanent changes.
-

We remain committed to maintaining compliance with all NPDES permit conditions and EGLE regulations. Please do not hesitate to contact me at (231) 306-8084 or via email at pmiller@cadillac-mi.net should you require additional information or clarification regarding this response.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink, consisting of a large, stylized 'P' followed by a long, sweeping horizontal line that ends in a small loop.

Patrick Miller
Water Resources Supervisor
City of Cadillac – Utilities Department